CHRISCO

CENTRAL YOUTH · NAIROBI

TREASURE TUESDAY SERIES

Accountability, forgiveness and the long road back — for the whole church



Cancel Culture vs Grace Culture

creating a balance between them

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FULL OF LIFE · FULL OF COLOUR



The Question We Cannot Dodge

How do we hold people accountable for wrong doing, without denying them the possibility of redemption? Culture is the shared beliefs, values and customs of a group — and the way a group treats someone who has fallen says more about it than any statement of faith.

Cancel Culture:

A collective boycotting — a community withdrawing support from someone because of what they said or did. At institutional level it can serve public accountability. Left unchecked it turns into a crowd that enjoys the fall.

Grace Culture:

The free, unmerited favour of God. Grace never licenses sin without consequences; it opens the way back to whoever is willing to walk it — and it keeps that way open far longer than our patience does.

Six Things We Must Hold

Distinctions the church loses at its own cost.



Forgiveness Is Not Trust

You can forgive someone who betrayed you without handing them access to your life again. Trust is rebuilt over time.



Grace Is Not the Absence of Consequence

The one who steals may be forgiven and still have to return the money. Repentant leaders can still face discipline.



Restoration Is Not Automatic Reinstatement

Being received back is not the same as being handed the old position, platform or keys on the same afternoon.



Mercy Must Not Erase the Victim

Care for the person who was hurt belongs in the same sentence as mercy for the one who hurt them.



Safety, Justice and Boundaries Matter

Boundaries are not a failure of love. Protection and honest process are how love behaves in public.



Discipline and Mercy Must Coexist

Forgiveness and justice are compatible. The cross is the proof — and there is a thin line between accountability and bullying.



What the Scriptures Say

Grace is not the absence of correction, and correction is not the absence of grace. Scripture exposes the works of darkness — and refuses to make a spectacle of the person.

Matthew 18:15–17

"Go and point out the fault, just between the two of you." Private first, witnesses only then, the wider circle last — every step aimed at winning them back.

1 Corinthians 5:1–13

Paul removes the unrepentant sinner from the community so that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord. Discipline with a redemptive end, never a spiteful one.

Ephesians 5:11

"Have nothing to do with the unfruitful works of darkness, but instead expose them." Grace does not tolerate serious wrong doing indefinitely.

Proverbs 28:13

Whoever conceals their transgressions does not prosper, but whoever confesses and forsakes them finds mercy. Confession is the doorway mercy walks through.

2 Corinthians 2:6–8

Paul then urges the church to forgive and comfort the disciplined person, so that he is not overwhelmed by excessive sorrow. Discipline that never ends was never discipline.

The G·R·A·C·E Framework

Practical steps for accountability with grace — a shape you can use on a Tuesday night.

G

Get the Facts

Before you speak, before you post, before you withdraw. Proverbs 18:13 — to answer before listening is folly and shame. Hear both sides first.

R

Recognise the Harm

Name what was actually done, and who it cost. Do not minimise it for comfort, and do not inflate it for effect.

A

Accountability Remains

Appropriate consequences still apply. Love does not waive them; it walks with the person through them.

C

Choose Compassion

Challenge the wrong doing without dehumanising the wrong doer. Nobody is the worst thing they have ever done.

E

Encourage Genuine Change

Is there evidence of repentance — changed behaviour, and a willingness to make amends? Not just a well-written apology.

+

Make Room for Restoration

Without rushing it. Restoration is a road, not an event, and it is not ours to set the pace of.



Balance in Practice

We need to learn the difference between public shaming and public accountability. These are the checks we keep applying to ourselves.

Private First, Public Last

Confrontation follows Matthew 18: one person, then two or three, then the church. Skipping to the crowd is not courage.

Exposing Is Not a Licence for Rumour

Calling wrongdoing into the light never authorises gossip, screenshots for sport, or a half story told loudly.

Do Not Be Selective

Do not be selective about what you count as moral. The standard that convicts your rival must also convict you.

The Goal Is Restoration

Not the satisfaction of watching someone fall. If you are quietly hoping for the fall, check your own heart first.

Do Not Repay Evil for Evil

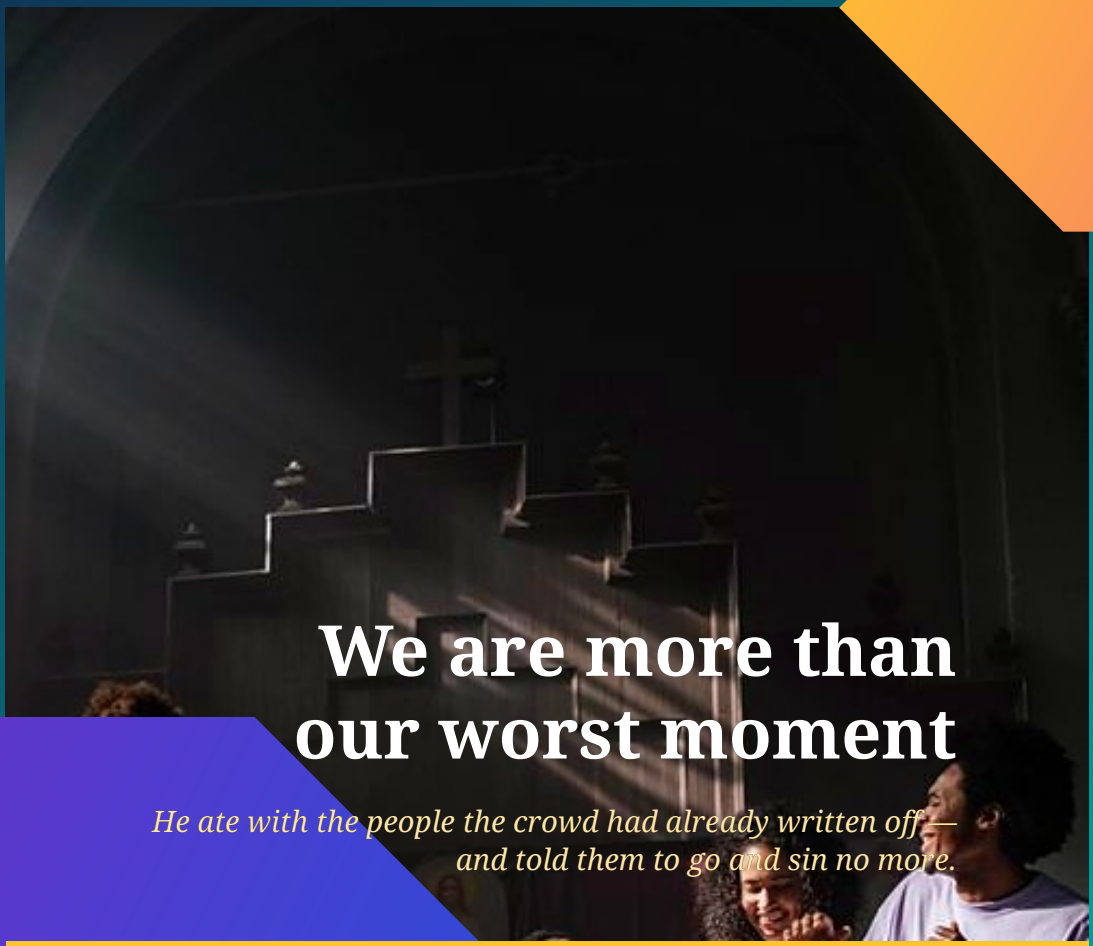
Romans 12:17. The cycle stops with us: no answering a wrong with a bigger wrong and calling the excess justice.

Truth and Grace, Together

We serve a God who calls sin what it is, who confronts wrongdoing, and who still offers mercy to those who repent.

THE HEART OF THE MATTER

What would Jesus do?



We are more than our worst moment

He ate with the people the crowd had already written off — and told them to go and sin no more.

The same grace we celebrate when God extends it to us must shape how we treat other people.



Set Your Mind on Things Above

"Set your minds on things above, not on earthly things. For you have died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God." — Colossians 3:2–3

Hidden — not from others

When your identity is rooted in who Jesus is and what He has done — not in what you dig up inside yourself — you live life to its truest, undistracted by whatever momentary message is dictating how you feel about yourself.

Protected — by Christ

When you hide your identity in Christ it is not hidden from others; it is protected by Christ. No verdict, no viral moment and no committee of one gets to write the final sentence about you.

Over to You

A few gems to carry into the week — kila mtu aende a reflect.

Reflect

1. If the Bible calls us to confront sin, at what point does confrontation become condemnation?
2. When someone falls, what do I feel first — grief for them, or the small pleasure of being proved right?
3. Who have I already written off that God is still pursuing — and what would it cost me to believe He can still reach them?

Assignment · for next Tuesday

Answer all three in writing, in one page. Then do one of these before you meet again: send the message you should have sent, restore the thing you took, or sit with the person nobody else is speaking to.

Memorise

"The goal is restoration, not the satisfaction of watching another person fall."

This we believe

Grace is not the absence of consequences, and consequences are not the absence of grace.

Pray for both of them

Pray for the one who did the wrong, that God would really change them. Pray for the one who was hurt, that God would really heal them. Leave the verdict where it belongs.

You Are Welcome Here

Treasure Tuesdays:

Every Tuesday · youth fellowship at CHRISCO Central, Nairobi
All are welcome — doors open fifteen minutes before we start



Written and taught by
Minister Naomi Njoki

Series · Treasure Tuesday, 2026
Title · Cancel Culture vs Grace Culture
Balance · truth that refuses to destroy, grace that refuses to excuse

FULL OF LIFE

Let this book be full of life and full of colour. CHRISCO Central Youth Nairobi